

Q: In Davos earlier this year, you talked about the next phase of globalisation. Is India a part of that?

A: I can tell you [that in] the next phase of globalisation, I see India as a clear winner. Look at all the geopolitical tensions going on—between the US and China, and what’s happening in Russia. During my recent visit, the interest was high among all the other CEOs visiting [the country]—from car manufacturers to chemical companies—to invest in India, because the supply chains will change.

What companies are looking for is a market where you have great talent and an environment to invest. You have to have the infrastructure, and the government needs to have a vision when it comes to sustainability, making it easier for companies to invest. And when you look at all of that, I feel India will be the winner because a lot of companies are choosing to invest in countries where they see all of these, to be successful in the future.

Q: SAP was an enterprise resource planning (ERP) software company and then you migrated to the cloud. What is the next big technology you are looking at?

A: When I look at all our customers in India—no matter if it’s large enterprises like Tata, or HCL [or the mid-market ones]—they want to move fast. And this is what they get in the cloud [where] we can continuously ship new innovations. I really like how all our customers are embracing this journey. Mid-market customers also have high ambitions to grow their business, and for them, we have an offer called Grow with SAP, where we give them the industry’s best practices with the software to scale or accelerate, and to rise to the top in the industry.

What comes next? You have seen what is possible with AI... now we are taking AI to the next level. In the future, Generative AI will help our customers in India ask any kind of business-related question. And the software will give you intelligent answers, will give you recommendations to make more informed decisions that help you better manage your business, or to access new capabilities. And you have to have the best

ON WHAT COMPANIES WANT

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ON USING TECHNOLOGY

A big trend in India is the move to clean energy. Indian energy providers say they are interested in using tech to move to clean energy. Or take the very successful car manufacturers in India... they want to change the way people buy and consume all the services in and outside of a car. They need tech for that

ON INDIA'S CONTRIBUTION

Our biggest ecosystem is in India—HCL, TCS, Wipro, Infosys—SAP cannot be successful without our partners in India. They are helping us to bring the software to all corners of the world. You have the biggest ecosystem now helping us to develop, implement, and want our software. This is India

workforce—it’s all about the people. Generative AI can help us close the skills gap by helping educate your workforce in the best possible way. And that happens with AI now, not just by human endeavour.

Q: What are you doing to make it responsible Artificial Intelligence?

A: When it comes to AI, we have appointed a board of external advisors who are making sure that our AI is developed in a responsible way. This means we are applying the right values [to the AI] and there [is] no bias in the algorithms. This [board] makes sure [that not only do] customers see all the benefits but that we are also applying AI in a responsible way.

Q: You talked about Generative AI. What will you focus on in the future?

A: I’ve spoken a lot about the business network (a B2B collaboration platform connecting processes, and devices across multiple enterprises, digitising transactions, and creating transparent, resilient, and sustainable supply chains). And I would love to give you a little bit more insight into why I feel this is the crown jewel in our portfolio and will change the way how businesses run.

Many Indian companies have faced certain supply chain restrictions and disruptions due to the high demand for certain raw materials. For example, the need for chips in the car industry. And to lift the business network, we are connecting the supply chains of car manufacturers, services companies, life sciences [companies, and more]. What you will get is a certain visibility—end to end—across your supply chain to make sure there are no disruptions.

Now, we will also track and trace the carbon footprint. So, in the future, when you buy new products or new ingredients for your products with SAP systems, our Green Ledger initiative can track and trace the carbon footprint—not only from your direct suppliers, but also from all of their suppliers—to make sure you can measure the carbon footprint, including Scope 3 emissions. We are standardising this in Green Ledger so that our customers not only gain more transparency around green-